unambiguously appreciated his thesis for its contribution to its area of study. He earned his degree in the last week of October 2002, which he immediately sent for attestation and authentication to the Embassy of Jordan. He booked his return air ticket to Jordan for 14 November 2002. This ticket was confirmed. But all was not over for Qays; the worst was yet to come.

On 7 November 2002, Qays went to the Foreigners' Registration Regional Office (FRRO) with all his documents to inform the office of his date of departure and to obtain permission for the same. He handed over all his documents, including passport and ticket, for due procedure. He was asked to wait, but his documents were not returned to him, nor was he given any information. After waiting for nearly three hours, Qays rang up N.D. Pancholi, his lawyer and a civil rights activist, to inform him of all that had happened at the FRRO. Pancholi advised him to wait as per official advice. Qays rang Pancholi again at 4 p.m. that day and informed him that he had not been given any information by the office, nor were his papers being returned. Pancholi asked him to call back in an hour. When he hadn't heard from Qays till well after that time, Pancholi went to the FRRO where, with some difficulty, he learnt that Qays had been sent to the Lampur Detention Centre. Pancholi was unable to ascertain the reason for his detention but was informed that there were some instructions 'from above'. Pancholi acted immediately and sent telegrams to the home minister, the police commissioner and the FRRO about Qays's illegal detention.

The following day (8 November 2002), the *Hindustan Times, Indian Express* and the *Times of India* carried reports about Qays's detention. According to these reports, the reason given by the FRRO for his detention was that Qays's air ticket was 'not confirmed'. The reports went on to state that Qays would be deported by the FRRO on the ticket bought by Qays himself, in order to 'ensure his departure'. The reason given by the FRRO was clearly spurious, since Qays's ticket was confirmed, and this could be easily proved. In any event, at no point was any explanation given by the FRRO to Qays himself as to why he was being detained, and why he would be deported.

Fearing for Qays's safety and life, two teachers of Delhi University, Nandita Narain and myself, immediately moved a habeas corpus petition on 8 November 2002 in the Delhi High Court (No. CRLW 1287/2002). The division bench comprising Justice D. Bhandari and Justice H.R. Malhotra asked the Centre and the Delhi Police to produce Qays in court the coming